

Joseph Reed Gaines

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Professional Summary

Full-stack software engineer, educator, and writer. Over five years of software experience spanning contract work and enterprise teams. Fluent in Agile processes and an advocate for developer efficiency and cross-functional collaboration, with a growing focus on product, QA, and project management. As an educator, I have taught at the college level, led continuing education programs for adult learners, substitute taught in secondary schools, and tutored one-on-one.

Projects

Canteen, 2025–Present

- An app for storing and sharing recipes, built with an AI-augmented workflow, using Claude Code to scaffold components, generate test cases, and speed up debugging, with every PR reviewed by hand.
- React frontend consuming Node.js/Express microservices with PostgreSQL DBs, with shared authentication and 2FA, backing up data to an S3 bucket via a nightly cron job.
- Deployed via a GitHub Actions CI/CD pipeline delivering Dockerized applications to a self-managed Kubernetes cluster (using Nginx Ingress) on Akamai Cloud.

Experience

Windham NE Supervisory Union, Windham, VT • *Substitute Teacher* • Oct 2025 - June 2026

- Taught classes of up to 30 students across all subject areas and grade levels, delivering prepared lesson plans and adapting pacing to group readiness.
- Reported instructional outcomes to permanent faculty, maintaining continuity across departments.

Squarespace, New York, NY • *Software Engineer* • Sept 2021 – Sept 2024

- Delivered production code daily for the Squarespace Help Center and core product, building and maintaining a custom React-based Zendesk CMS theme with consistent rendering across desktop, tablet, and mobile web.
- Collaborated with designers and product owners to architect and implement an AI-powered support chatbot, building live-support handoff flows in support of a company-wide initiative to apply AI to user productivity.
- Led a redesign of Help Center home and article pages, introducing content placeholders that minimized layout shift and significantly improved core web vitals.

- Wrote and verified unit tests using Jest for React components and JUnit/Mockito for Java/Spring services, sustaining above 90 percent code coverage.

Econify, New York, NY · *Software Engineer* · May 2019 – Sept 2021

- Developed a revamped article and buyer's guide platform for MotorTrend using server-side rendering, optimizing critical rendering paths to increase page performance tenfold and achieve top-tier rankings on industry web performance benchmarks.
- Delivered daily deployments for high-traffic media clients, streamlining third-party ad implementations to increase viewability 400 percent.
- Managed full-stack services spanning Postgres databases, Node services, and React frontends across concurrent client engagements.

Pursuit, New York, NY · *Head of Web Instruction / Lead Instructor* · Nov 2017 – May 2019

- Led three cohorts of approximately 35 adult engineers-in-training through an immersive 10-month full-stack development program built on the PERN stack.
- Oversaw curriculum development and code review, establishing standards for maintainable code and modern version control practice.
- Mentored junior developers on debugging, architectural decision-making, and career readiness across the full length of the program.

University of Wisconsin, Madison, WI · *Assoc. University Relations Specialist* · Dec 2016 - Jul 2017

- Disseminated and implemented a landmark qualitative study and information module on young adults with depression.
- Owned content editorial, website design, and web promotion, measuring reach through web traffic analysis and user feedback.
- Represented the module onsite at national mental health conferences.

Brown University, Providence, RI · *Graduate Instructor* · Sep 2015 - May 2016

- Designed and taught two undergraduate courses in Digital Language Arts from scratch, setting syllabi, sequencing, and assessment criteria independently.
- Held regular office hours, working closely with students on projects and skill gaps.

Google, Ann Arbor, MI · *Associate Account Strategist* · Aug 2013 - Aug 2014

- Consulted with account managers on online marketing strategy across a large book of business.
- Served on the Policy team, translating front-line advertiser issues into ongoing advertising policy development.

Education

App Academy, New York, NY · 2017

- 1000-hour immersive full-stack web development course (3% acceptance rate).

Brown University, Providence, RI · 2014 – 2016

- MFA, Digital Language Arts

Vassar College, Poughkeepsie, NY · 2009 – 2013

- BA, English
- Graduated with Departmental Honors